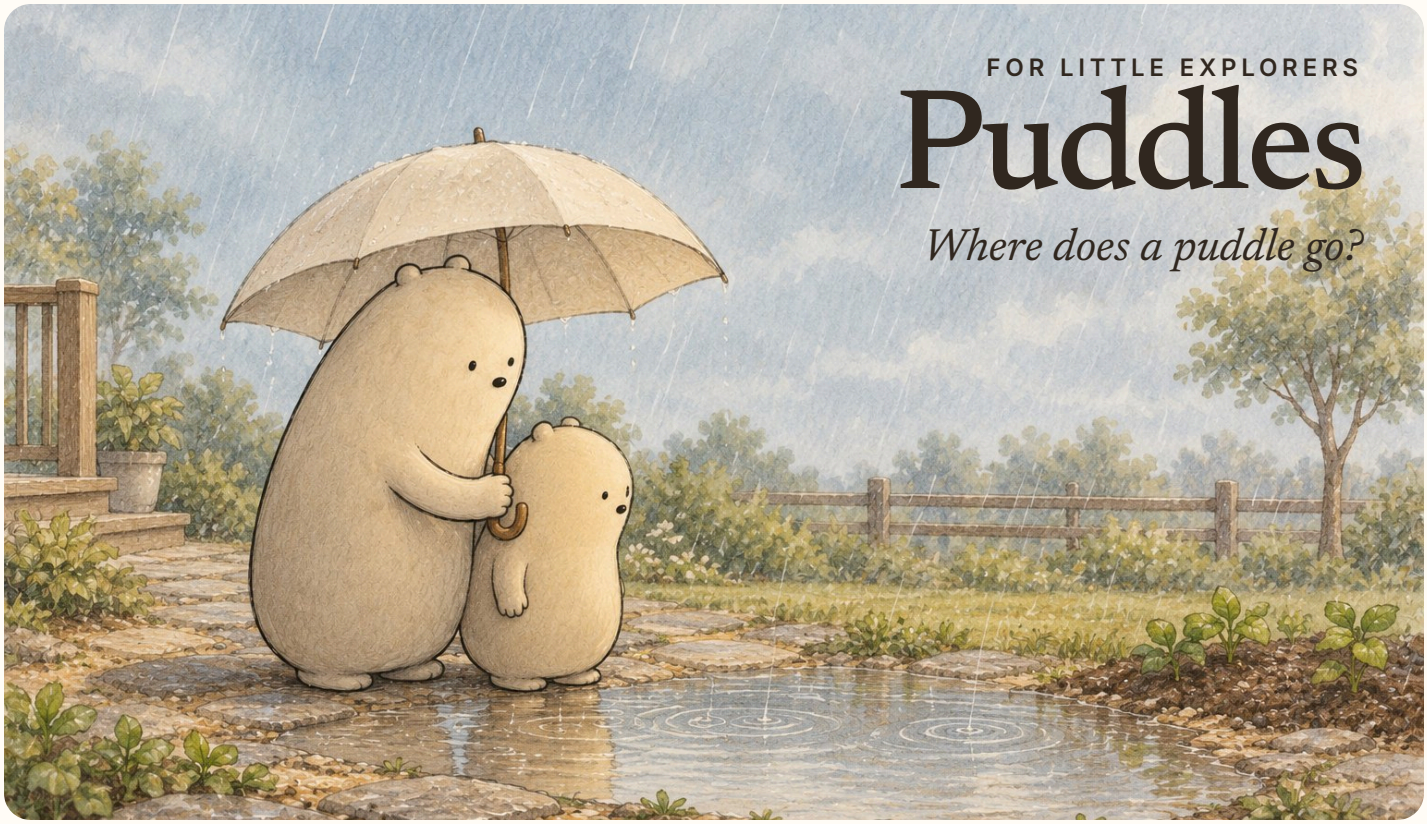


READ ALOUD

Plip. Plop. Plip. (Tap your fingers on the table like rain.) *It is raining in the garden. Big Wonderer holds the umbrella, and Little Wonderer stands close.*

Look: the rain runs along the path and gathers in a low dip. That is how a puddle is made. Water slides to the lowest place, and it waits there.

ASK **Where would the water stop on our street?**

Little Wonderer gives one small hop. **SPLASH!** *Drops jump up like a crown, and rings spread out, out, out.* (Draw a ring in the air.)

When the rain stops, the puddle becomes a mirror. ASK **What can you see in it?**

Then the sun comes out, and the puddle starts to go away. Some water soaks down into the soil, where the roots drink. Some rises into the warm air, in bits too small to see. Some trickles downhill to the garden bed.

ASK **Which way do you think our puddle went?**

Big Wonderer smiles at the sky. "The clouds will bring it back." And they wave goodbye, until the next rain.

Inside: a puddle story · splash science · where puddles go · first-next-last · spot the difference · a maze · counting to 20 · shapes and colors · rhymes and letter sounds · tracing and snipping · a coloring page · and a fold-up picture book.

How a puddle is made



Rain finds the low spot

Rain falls on the whole garden. The water slides along the stones until it reaches the lowest dip. There it gathers into a puddle.

ASK Point to the lowest spot in the picture.



Splash science

When Little Wonderer lands, the water has to get out of the way. It jumps up as a crown of drops and spreads out as rings.

ASK Trace the rings with your finger. How many can you find?



A mirror on the ground

When the water is very still, it is smooth like a mirror, so it shows the sky and the two friends, upside down.

ASK Can you find the cloud in the puddle?

TRY IT WITH A GROWN-UP Fill a bowl with water. Wait until it is still and look in. Then tap it once with a finger. What happens to the mirror?

Where does a puddle go?

The sun is out. Little by little, the puddle shrinks. The water does not disappear. It goes three ways.



It soaks in

The ground has tiny spaces between bits of soil. Water slips into them, and the roots drink it.



It floats up

Warm sun turns water into bits too small to see. They float up and help make new clouds.



It trickles away

Water always runs to a lower place. Down the slope it goes, carrying a leaf.



The puddle is gone

Only a pale ring is left on the stones, to show where the puddle was.

ASK **Point: which way did the water go: down, up, or downhill?**

(Every answer is right: it went all three ways.)

Round and round. *The water that floats up gathers into clouds. The clouds rain again, and a new puddle fills the low dip. The same water goes round and round: puddle, air, cloud, rain, puddle.*

EXPERIMENT WITH A GROWN-UP Put one spoon of water on a plate and one spoon on a paper towel. Which one soaks it up? Put the plate in a sunny window and check it after lunch.

Which splash is whose?

Big Wonderer drops three things into the puddle, one at a time. Plop, kerSPLOOSH, and... shhh.

1 Draw a line with your finger from each thing to its splash.



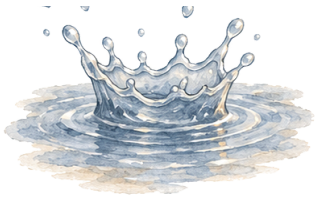
a little pebble



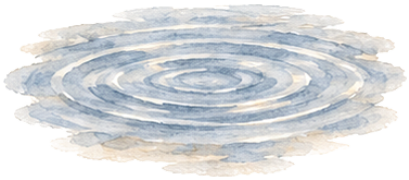
a big stone



a feather



big splash



tiny ripple



small splash

WHY? Heavier things push more water out of the way, so the splash jumps higher. A feather is so light that it only makes a gentle ripple.

2 Shapes and colors in the garden

Point to each shape, then say its color with your grown-up.



blue circle

A round puddle is a circle.



green triangle

A pointy leaf tip is a triangle.



brown square

A flat path stone is a square.



yellow oval

A splash ring is an oval.

ASK Can you find something round, like a circle, in your room?

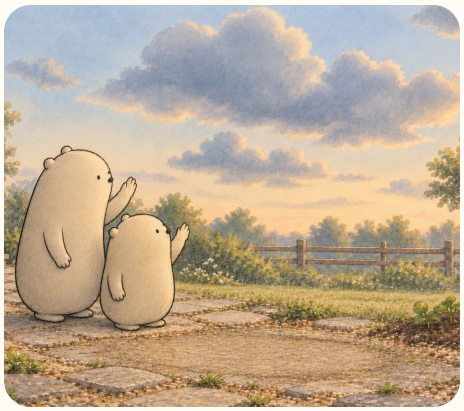
What happened first?

Grown-up: point to each picture and tell it in a few words. Then ask which came first, next and last. Little explorer circles 1, 2 or 3 under each picture.

1 Before, during and after the rain



1 2 3



1 2 3



1 2 3

clouds come · rain falls · the puddle is a mirror

2 The puddle goes away



1 2 3



1 2 3



1 2 3

a big puddle · a smaller puddle · only a ring

TALK ABOUT IT What would happen next if the clouds came back?

Spot 5 differences

The two pictures look the same, but 5 things changed. Point to each one, then circle it in the bottom picture. Color a dot for each one you find.

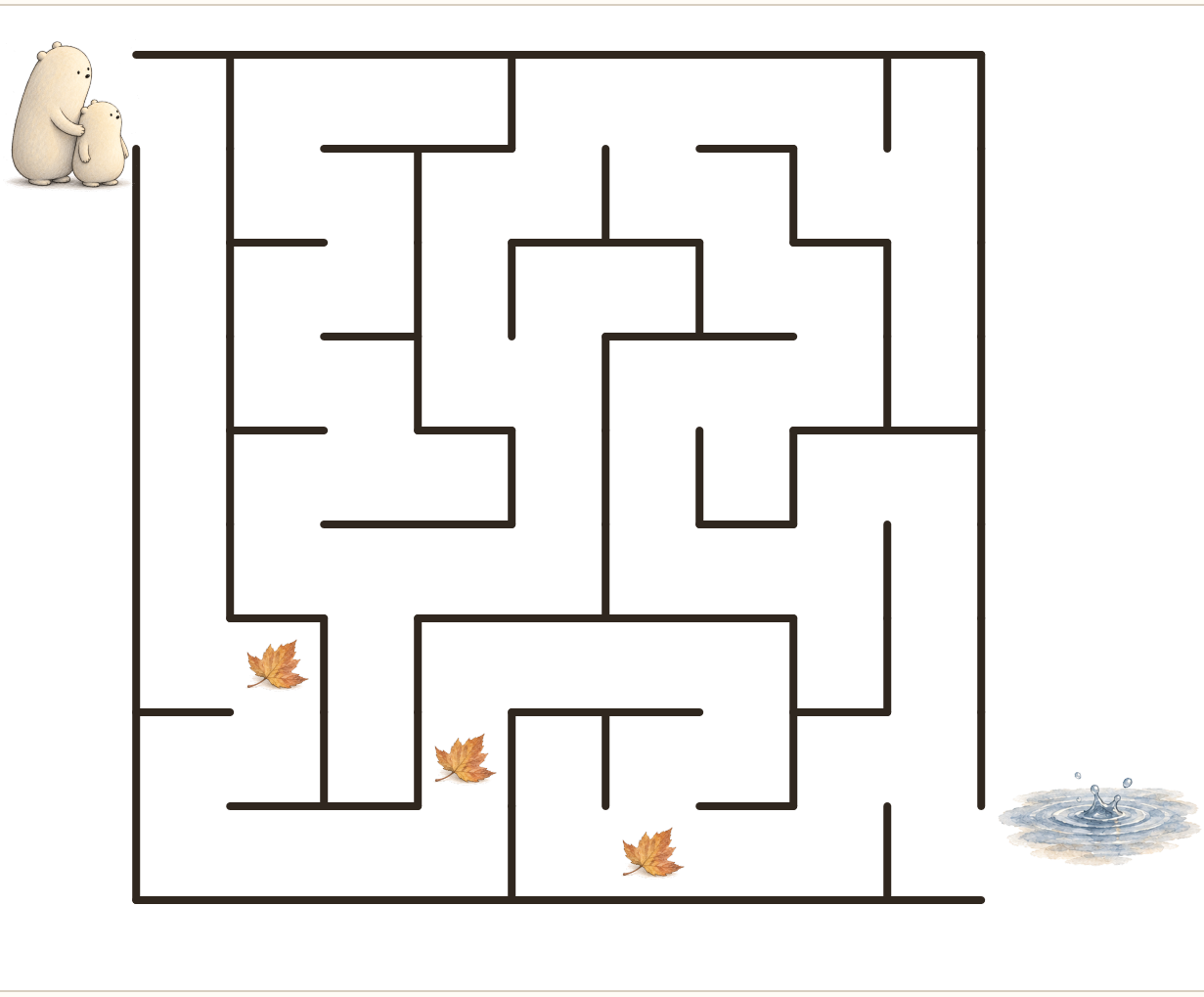


I found: ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Follow the trickle

The water is running downhill to the garden puddle. Help Big and Little Wonderer follow it, and pick up the three leaves floating along the way.

First, trace the way with a finger.
Then, touch each leaf as you pass it.
Last, do it again with a crayon.

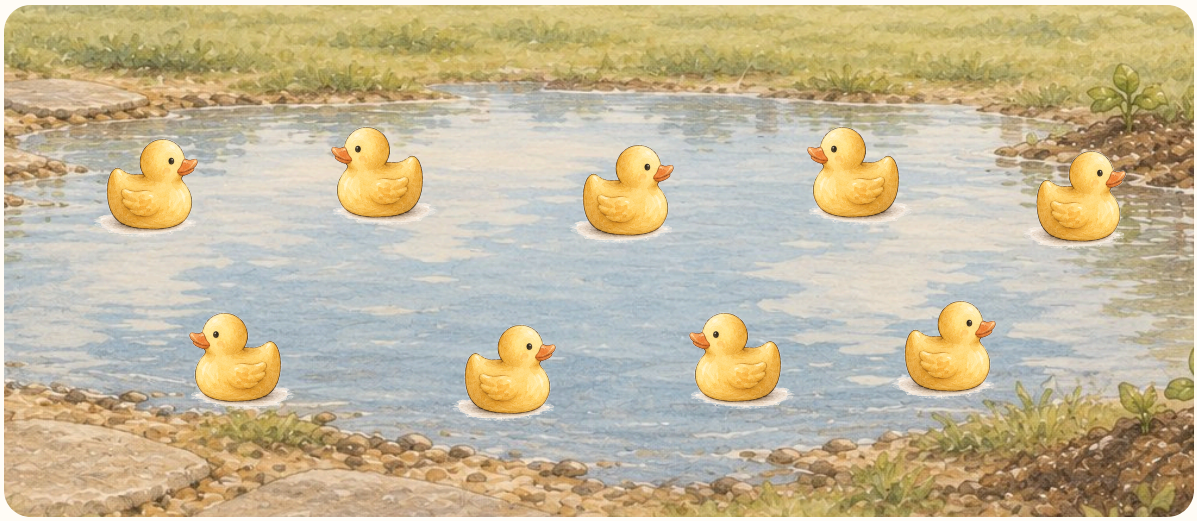


Leaves picked up:

WHY DOWNHILL? Water always runs to a lower place. That is why the trickle starts at the top and ends in the low garden puddle.

Puddle count

1 Count the ducks. Circle how many.

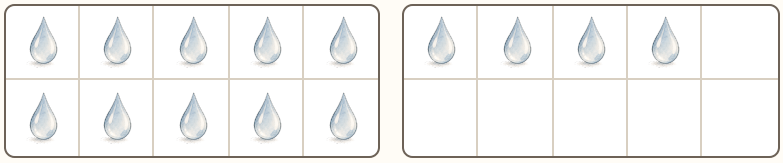


Touch each duck once as you count. Put a crayon dot on each duck you touch.

8 9 10 12

2 Count the raindrops. Circle the number.

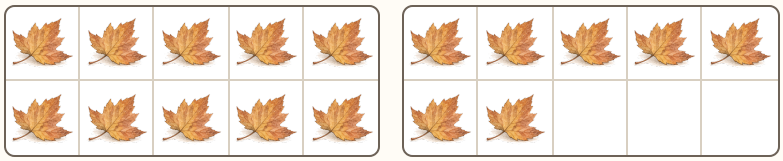
One full frame is 10. Then count on: 11, 12…



13 14 16

3 Count the leaves. Circle the number.

10 and some more.



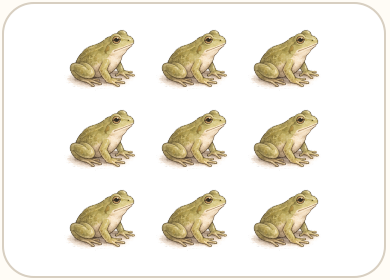
15 17 20

4 Find the number 12. Circle it.

7 12 15 20 10

5 Point to the group with MORE.

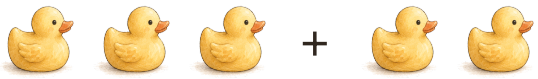




Puddle stories

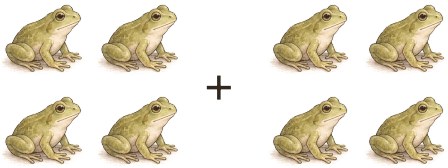
A stretch, just for fun. Grown-up reads each little story. Count the first group, then count on with the second group. Little explorer circles the answer.

3 ducks are swimming. 2 more ducks paddle in. How many ducks now?



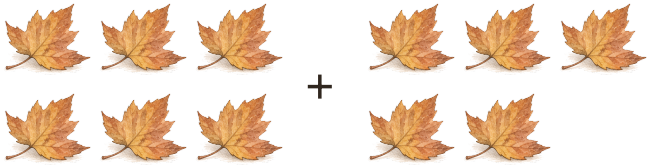
3 + 2 = (4) (5) (6)

4 frogs sit on one side. 4 frogs sit on the other side. How many frogs?



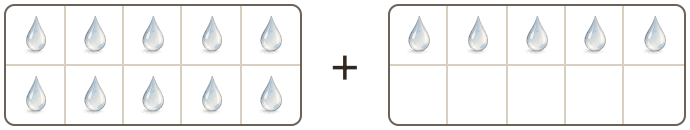
4 + 4 = (7) (8) (9)

6 leaves fell in the puddle. Then 5 more fell. How many leaves?



6 + 5 = (10) (11) (13)

10 raindrops fill the frame. 5 more drops fall. How many drops?



10 + 5 = (14) (15) (16)

Puddle sounds

M m

This is the letter M, m. It says /m/, like mmmud. Trace it in the air together.

1 Which pictures start with /m/, like *mud*? Circle them.


mud


sun


moon


pup


mop


mug

2 Rhyme time! Grown-up says the three words. Point to the two that rhyme.




mug bug sun



hen mop ten



pup mop hop

3 Read it together. Point to each word as you say it.


The pup is in the mud.



A bug sits on a mug.


4 Just for fun: touch each letter, then say the word fast.


m u d


b u g

Trace and snip

Count the pictures together. Trace the first number with a finger, then trace the dotted numbers with a crayon. Start at the dot.



1 1 1 1



2 2 2 2



3 3 3 3



4 4 4 4



5 5 5 5

Snip along the trickle

With a grown-up helping, snip along the wavy line from the raindrop to the puddle. Safety scissors, and a grown-up holds the paper.







Color the splash

First, color the umbrella blue.
Then, color the puddle any color you like.
Last, draw a circle around the leaf.

Try to stay inside the lines. Big and Little Wonderer can be any color you like.



Puddles

FOR LITTLE EXPLORERS

Puddles: where do they go?

1

Rain runs to the low spot.

2

Hop! Splash! Drops and rings.

3

The puddle is a sky mirror.

4

Some water soaks into the soil.

5

Some floats up into the air.

6

Some trickles away downhill.

7

The clouds will bring it back.

8

How to fold the picture book

1. Print the picture sheet on one page, landscape, at 100% (no scaling).
2. Fold it in half the long way, then open it. Fold it in half the short way, then in half again; open it flat.
3. **Grown-up only:** fold it in half the short way and cut along the middle fold from the folded edge to the center crease.
4. Open it, fold it the long way again, and push the ends together so the slit opens into a little book. Page 1 goes on the front.

Read it together: one picture, a few words on each page. Ask "what do you see?" before you turn the page.